



Plants for sandy soil

Water and nutrients drain through sandy soils, but many plants live happily on such meager rations and may rot or flower poorly if given a richer diet.

Choose plants that tolerate drought and dislike wet roots in winter for this free-draining soil. Lavender, African lily, statice, and other plants from Mediterranean climates thrive in sandy conditions, as do most bulbs. Fashionable prairie plants, including stonecrop, yarrow, salvia, and coneflower, are also at home in sandy, sunny sites, while wildflower meadows will put on their best performance here. If you are looking for larger, more permanent plants, choose from the many shrubs and trees that like drier conditions, such as spiraea, ninebark, and juniper.



PERENNIAL SMALL

Achillea 'Paprika'

YARROW An upright semievergreen perennial with feathery, silvery green leaves. In summer, it produces flat heads of tiny scarlet flowers that fade with age. The dried flower heads can be left to provide winter interest.

±18in (45cm)

☪ Z3-8 (N)



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Agapanthus africanus

AFRICAN LILY An evergreen perennial with strap-shaped midgreen leaves and spherical heads of deep blue trumpet-shaped flowers, which appear from summer to early fall on tall sturdy stems. Protect from frost in winter.

±3ft (1m) ↔ 20in (50cm)

☪ Z8-10



SHRUB MEDIUM

Abelia 'Edward Goucher'

ABELIA Deciduous or semievergreen, this arching shrub has oval, tapered green leaves that are bronze when young. From midsummer to fall, it produces masses of trumpet-shaped, pink, slightly fragrant blooms. Prune in spring.

±5ft (1.5m) ↔ 6ft (2m)

☪ Z6-9



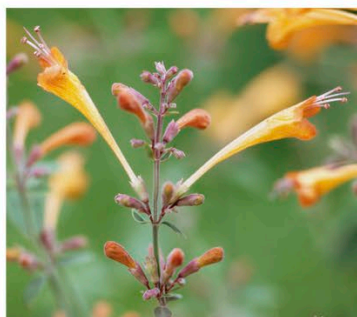
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Achillea 'Coronation Gold'

YARROW An upright perennial with fernlike gray-green foliage and flat heads of golden-yellow flowers in summer. The stems may need discreet support, ideally put into place in spring so the plants can grow up into them.

±3ft (1m) ↔ 24in (60cm)

☪ Z3-9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Agastache aurantiaca

GIANT HYSSOP An upright perennial with gray-green scented leaves and, in summer, long-lasting spikes of small, orange, two-lipped tubular flowers. Popular varieties include 'Apricot Sprite' (above), with pale orange blooms.

±20in (50cm) ↔ 3ft (1m)

☪ Z6-10 (N)



BULB MEDIUM

Allium cristophii

STARS OF PERSIA A summer-flowering bulb with narrow gray-green leaves that fade as the flowers appear. This short-stemmed allium then produces large balls of star-shaped violet flowers, followed by attractive seedheads.

±16in (40cm)

☪ (I) Z5-8



BULB MEDIUM

Alstroemeria ligtu hybrids

PERUVIAN LILY This summer-flowering tuber produces narrow twisted leaves and funnel-shaped flower heads in shades of pink, yellow, or orange, often spotted or streaked with contrasting colors. In cold areas, apply a deep mulch in winter.

±24in (60cm)

☪ (I) Z8-11



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Anthemis tinctoria

GOLDEN MARGUERITE This is a clump-forming perennial with finely divided, aromatic leaves. It bears a mass of white or yellow daisy-like flowers on slim stems over a long period in summer. 'E.C. Buxton' (above) has lemon-yellow flowers.

±3ft (1m)

☪ Z3-8



SHRUB SMALL

Artemisia 'Powis Castle'

WORMWOOD This rounded evergreen, subshrub is grown for its finely divided, silver leaves. The small, yellow late-summer flowers are often removed to maintain the plant's foliage effect. May need protection in cold winters.

±3ft (1m)

☪ Z7-9



PERENNIAL LARGE

Asphodeline lutea

YELLOW ASPHODEL A tall, upright, clump-forming perennial that produces narrow, textured grassy leaves and dense spikes of star-shaped, bright yellow fragrant flowers in late spring. The blooms are followed by decorative seedpods.

±4ft (1.2m) ↔ 3ft (1m)

☪ Z6-9